

A photograph of a wetland landscape. In the foreground, there is a pond with dark water, reflecting the sky and surrounding vegetation. Several clumps of tall, green reeds or grasses are growing out of the water. The middle ground is filled with a dense carpet of green ferns and other low-lying plants. In the background, a line of trees is visible under a cloudy sky.

Mulching *Molinia*

A presentation by Zhuchok for the Biodiverse server :3

The issue

- Purple Moor-grass (*Molinia caerulea*) grows on drying peat bogs, creating a monospecific vegetation assemblage.
- It further dries out the peat, which makes it harder for a biodiverse, wet loving bog community to flourish.
- Ombrotrophic peat bogs are very important for carbon storage, biodiversity, water management etc.



The sites

- There used to be a large peat-covered part of the Mersey Valley (near Manchester, UK), called Chat Moss.
- Now there are small relict bogs remaining.
- These were drained and used for peat cutting.
- Lancashire Wildlife Trust is now restoring them.
- Three sites: Astley Moss (Control); Astley Moss (Treated); Rindle Moss (Treated).

Astley



Rindle



Battling *Molinia*

- A small amount of *Molinia* is normal for a mire, however there was too much on these sites.
- Water tables were raised by blocking drains & constructing bunds.
- The plants were mulched, to hopefully weaken *Molinia*.



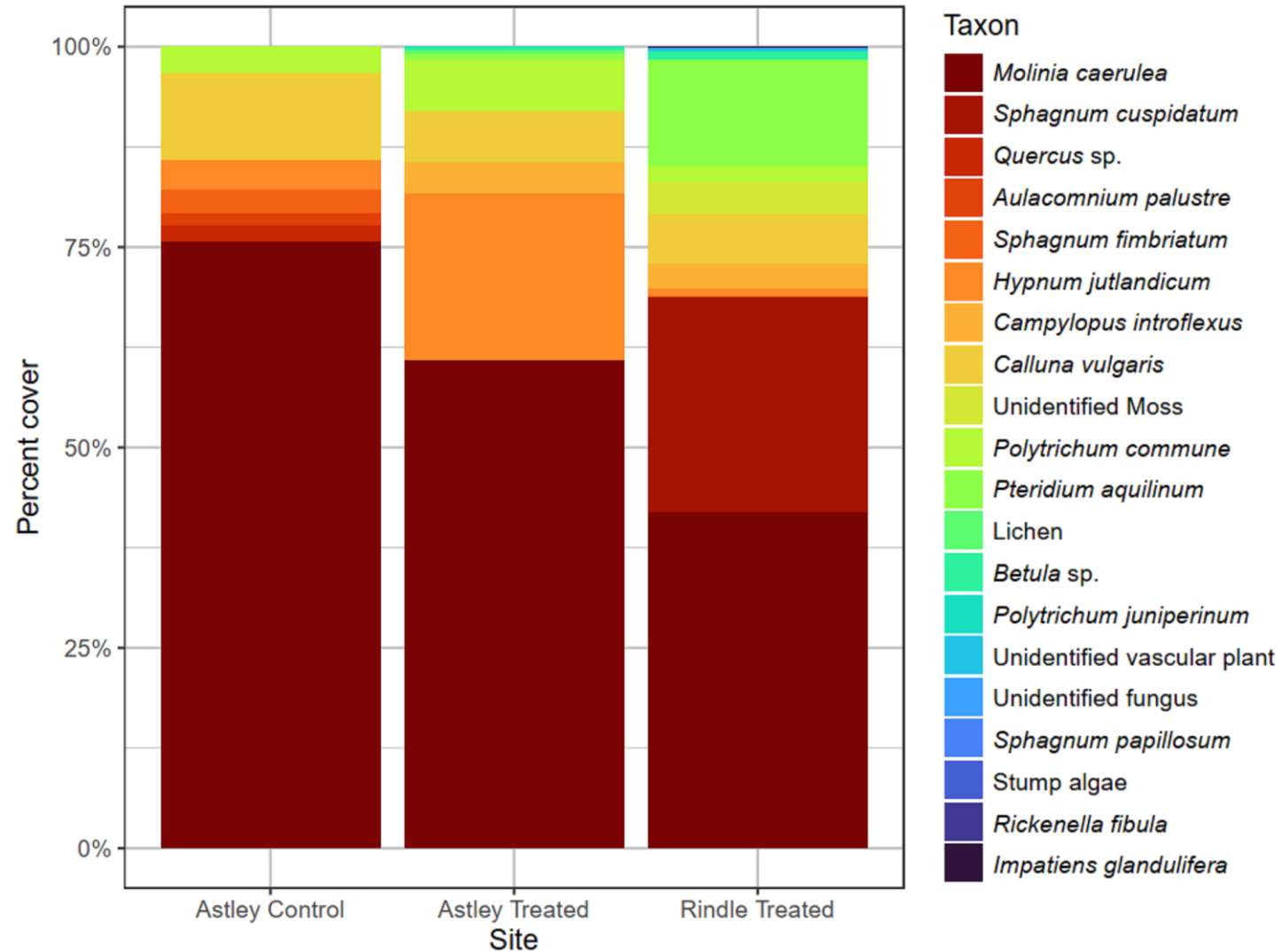


Astley

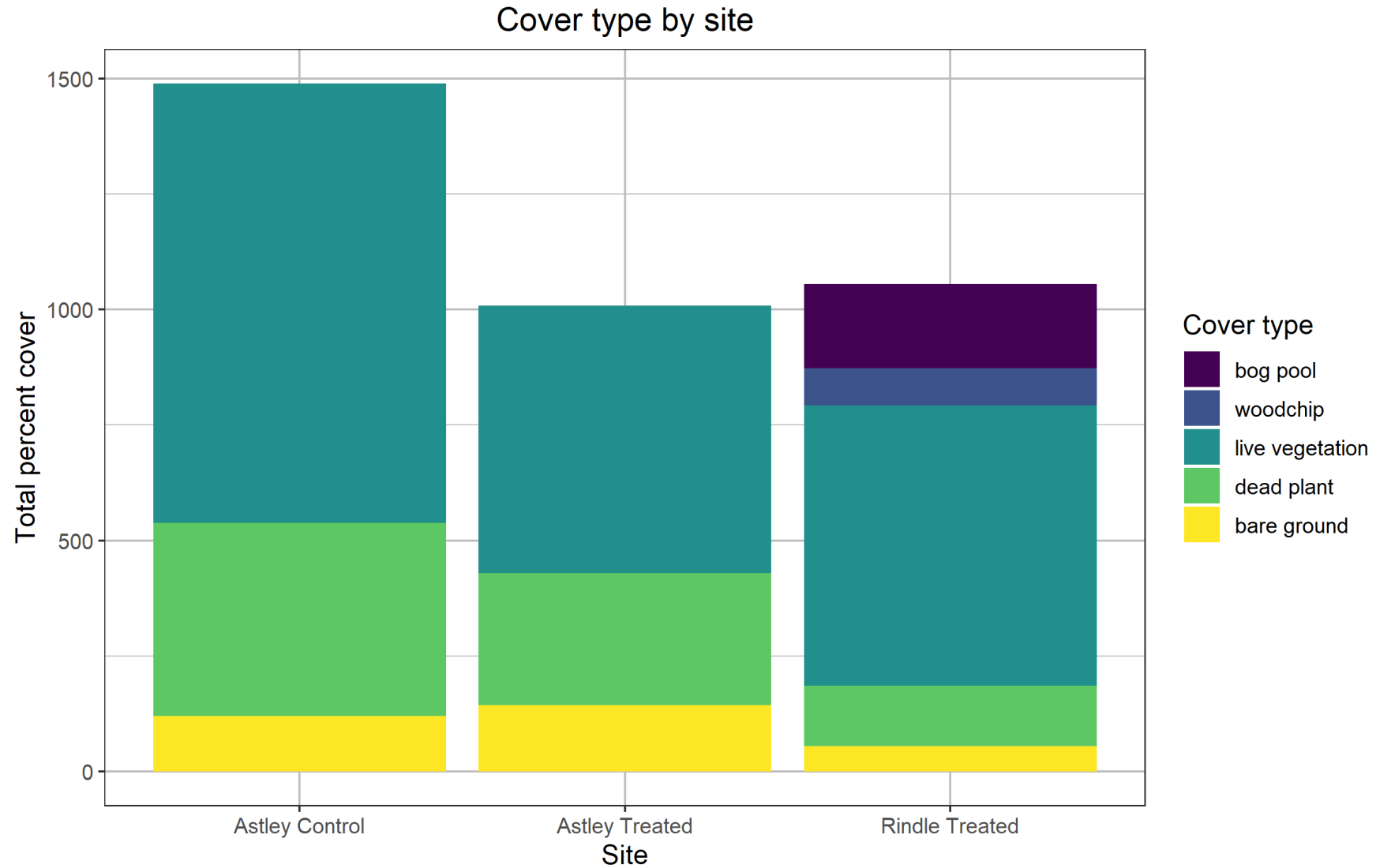


Rindle

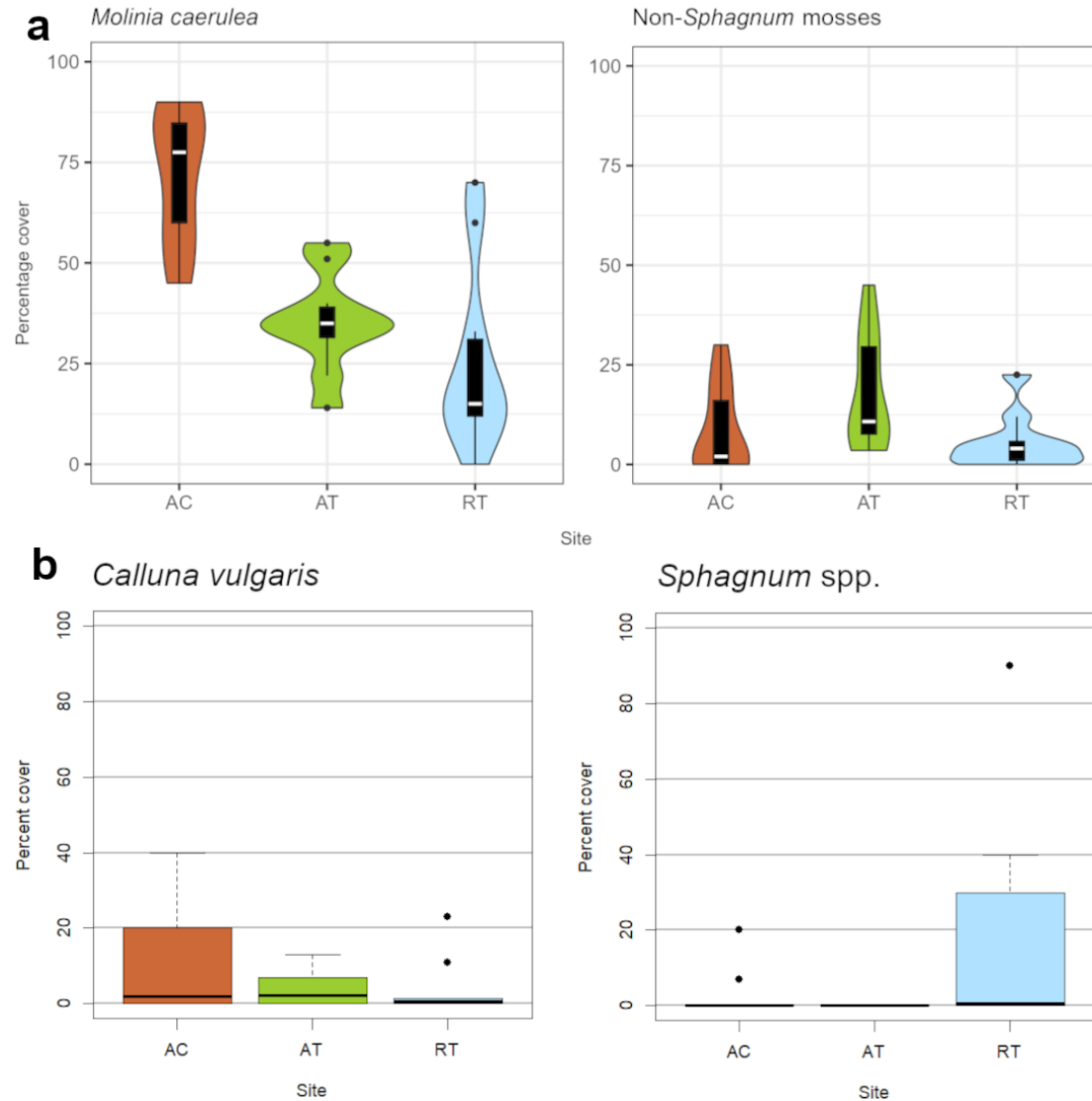
Results: vegetation



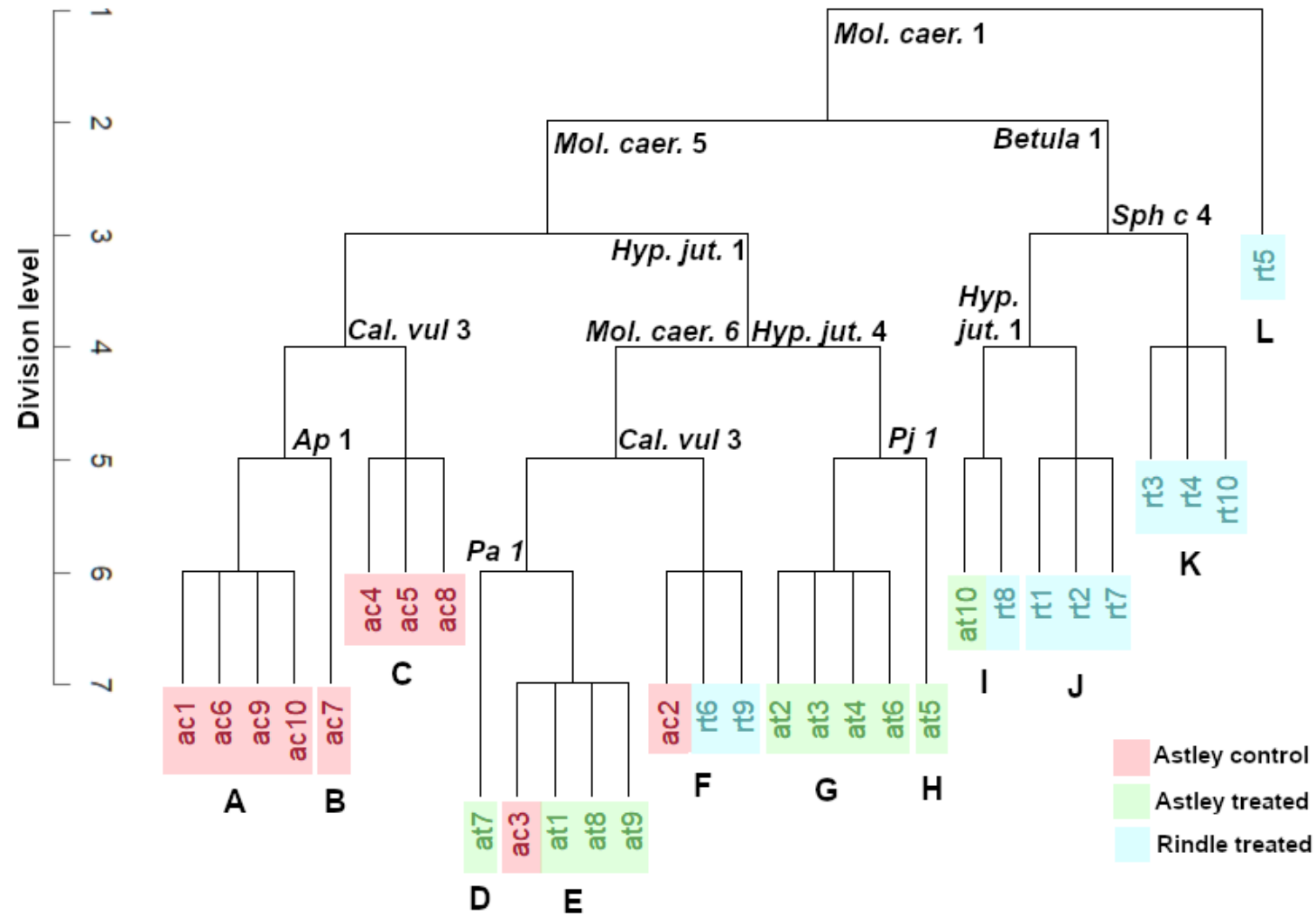
Results: cover type



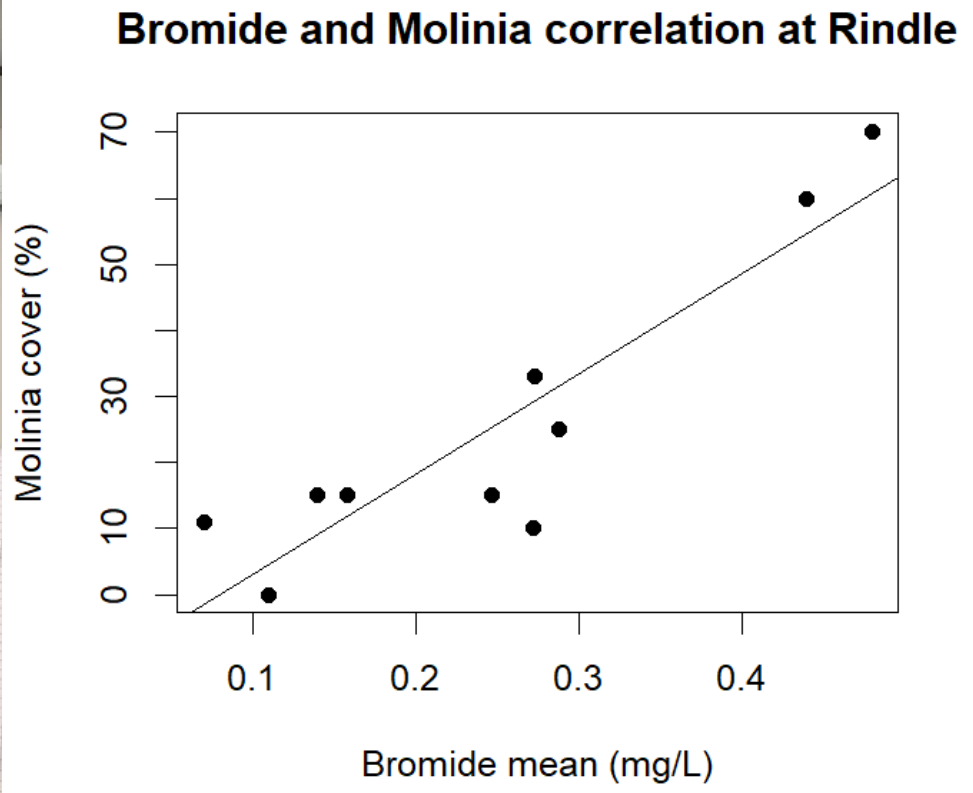
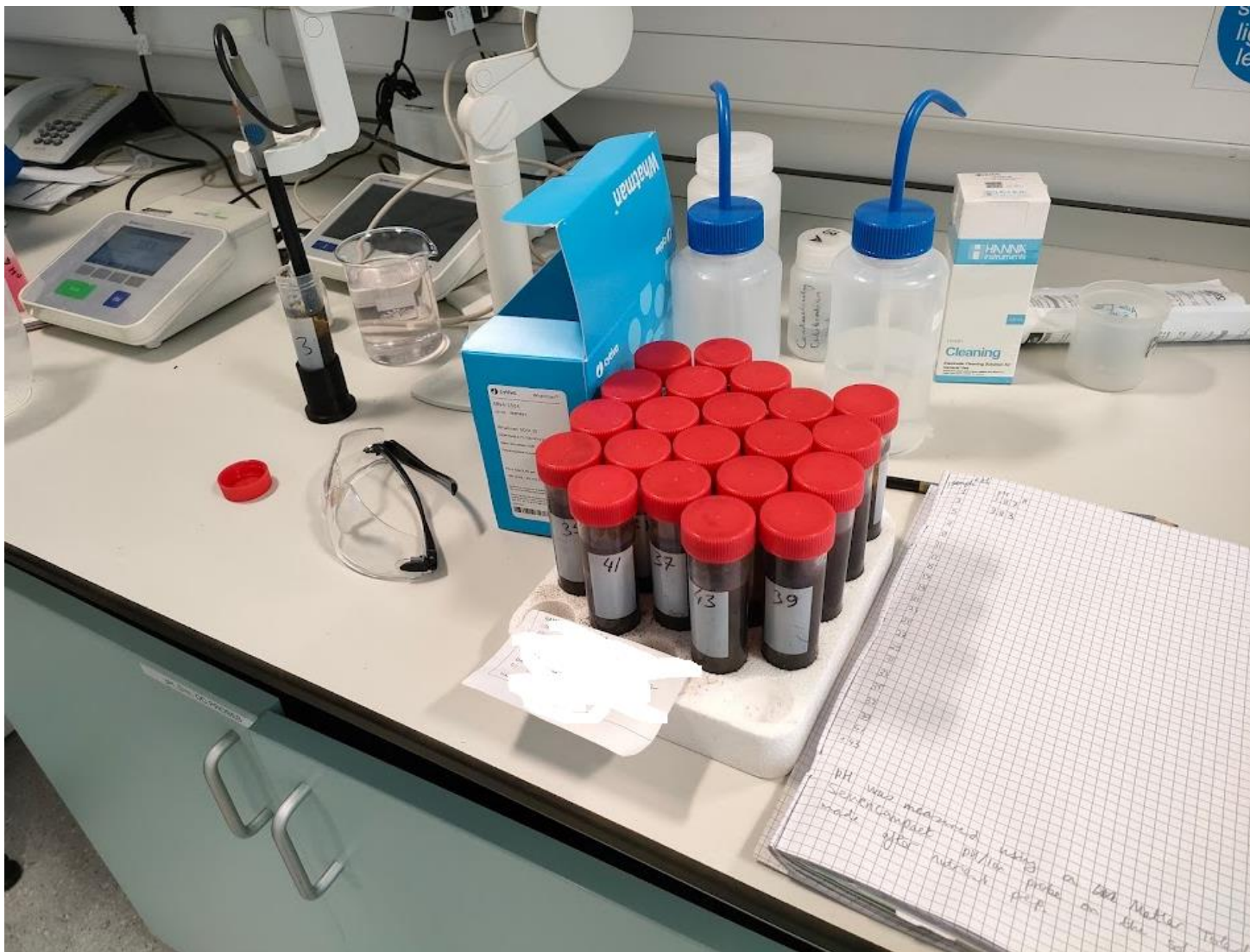
Results: key vegetation



Results: clustering







Thanks for
watching!

